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2026 elections: What you need to know about LA County's state Senate, Assembly races

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There are 32 legislative races – eight state Senate and 24 Assembly seats – on the Nov. 3 ballot where Los Angeles County voters will help decide the winner during this year's general election.

Eight of these races have no incumbent running.

In the state Senate, they include the 24th and 34th districts, where outgoing Sens. Ben Allen and Tom Umberg are facing term limits. Also, in the 26th District, Sen. María Elena Durazo did not seek reelection but instead ran for, and won, a seat on the L.A. County Board of Supervisors in June.

In the Assembly, five races feature no incumbent. That's because Assemblymembers Tom Lackey (District 34), Jacqui Irwin (District 42), Mike Gipson (District 65), Al Muratsuchi (District 66) and Sharon Quirk-Silva (District 67) are termed out.

There are also two races where the incumbent is running unopposed: Assemblymembers Mark Gonzalez and Tina McKinnor, who represent the 54th and 61st districts, respectively. Both are Democrats.

In many of these races, a candidate captured more than 50% of the vote in the June primary election. But for state legislative races, the top two vote-getters, regardless of political party, move on to the general election, even if one candidate received the majority of the vote in the primary.

Below is a breakdown of L.A. County's legislative races.

20th State Senate District

Sen. Caroline Menjivar, a Democrat seeking a second term, is running against Republican Tony Rodriguez, a construction recruitment manager.

SD-20 spans an area roughly bordered by Burbank, Sunland/Tujunga, Sylmar and Canoga Park in the northern and eastern portions of the San Fernando Valley.

22nd State Senate District

Democratic Sen. Susan Rubio, going for a third term, is facing Republican Mike Netter, a small business owner.

This district mostly represents communities in eastern San Gabriel Valley, including El Monte, Covina and Pomona. But it also includes parts of San Bernardino County, including Ontario and Chino.

24th State Senate District

West Hollywood Councilmember John Erickson and media consultant Brian Goldsmith are embroiled in one of the most expensive legislative races this cycle to see which Democrat will succeed term-limited Sen. Ben Allen, D-Santa Monica.

This largely coastal district stretches from the Santa Monica Mountains – including Agoura Hills, Calabasas and Malibu – to L.A.'s Westside and Hollywood area, and on down to the South Bay, taking in Redondo Beach, Torrance and Rancho Palos Verdes.

Erickson, who is chief of staff at Alliance for a Better Community, an L.A.-based organization whose mission is to advance social, economic and racial equity and justice, was first elected to the West Hollywood City Council in 2020.

Goldsmith, a Beverly Hills resident, has never been elected to office, though he worked on Hillary Clinton's 2000 U.S. Senate campaign and advised Pete Buttigieg during his 2020 presidential run.

Since the June primary election and up through mid-October the two candidates raised more than $3.2 million combined while outside "independent expenditure" groups poured at least another $5.8 million into the race.

26th State Senate District

This race pits Sara Hernandez, an affordable housing advocate and president of the Los Angeles Community College District board, against environmental advocate Sarah Rascón to see who will replace Sen. María Elena Durazo, who is moving on to serve on the L.A. County Board of Supervisors.

SD-26 stretches from L.A.'s Eagle Rock and Highland Park neighborhoods in the north, toward Los Feliz and Koreatown in the west, and Boyle Heights, East L.A. and the city of Vernon in the southeastern part of the district.

It's one of just two L.A. County state Senate races — the other being SD-24 — where both candidates on the ballot are Democrats.

They're also the only two Senate races in which the California Democratic Party did not endorse a candidate because the members of its endorsement caucus couldn't reach consensus.

And like the 24th District, the race in SD-26 is also among the more expensive legislative races in L.A. County this year.

Between the primary election and mid-October, more than $4.5 million have been spent by outside "independent expenditure" groups on ads, mailers and other expenses in hopes of influencing the outcome of this race.

28th State Senate District

Democratic Sen. Lola Smallwood-Cuevas, who is seeking a second term, is running against Republican businessman Joe Lisuzzo.

This district stretches from downtown L.A. west toward Mar Vista and Westchester and takes in most of South Central L.A., including Florence at its southeastern edge.

30th State Senate District

Sen. Bob Archuleta, a Democrat, wants a third and final term. To do that, he must fend off Republican challenger Araceli Martinez, a small business owner.

This district represents a portion of southeastern L.A. County and includes Downey, Norwalk and Whittier. It also dips into Orange County, picking up the community of Brea.

34th State Senate District

Democratic Assemblymember Avelino Valencia and former Placentia City Councilmember Rhonda Shader, a Republican, are vying to replace termed-out Sen. Tom Umberg, D-Santa Ana.

This district represents a portion of L.A. County, including South Whittier, but is mostly located in Orange County,

and includes the communities of Anaheim, Buena Park, Fullerton, La Habra and Santa Ana.

36th State Senate District

Republican Sen. Tony Strickland is facing off against former San Clemente City Councilmember Chris Duncan, a Democrat.

This largely coastal district includes Artesia, Cerritos and Hawaiian Gardens in Los Angeles County and a larger portion of Orange County, including Garden Grove, Westminster, Fountain Valley, Huntington Beach, Newport Beach, Dana Point and San Clemente.

34th Assembly District

Big Bear Lake Mayor Randall Putz, a Democrat, is in a runoff with Charles Frederick Hughes, a Republican, after the two advanced from a four-person primary race.

The winner will replace Assemblymember Tom Lackey, R-Palmdale, who is termed out.

The 34th District spans three counties: Los Angeles, San Bernardino and Kern, and includes the communities of Palmdale, Lancaster, Barstow, Lake Arrowhead, Big Bear Lake, and Twentynine Palms.

39th Assembly District

Assemblymember Juan Carrillo, D-Palmdale, faces Republican challenger Paul Andre Marsh as he seeks a third term.

This district takes in parts of Los Angeles and San Bernardino counties. It includes parts of northern Antelope Valley and stretches into the San Bernardino communities of Adelanto, Hesperia and Victorville.

40th Assembly District

Assemblymember Pilar Schiavo, D-Chatsworth, and Ricky Tracy Hayes II, a Republican entrepreneur and businessman, are facing off after advancing out of a four-person primary race.

Schiavo was first elected in 2022 and is seeking a third term.

The 40th District is entirely within L.A. County and represents communities in Santa Clarita Valley and northwestern San Fernando Valley.

41st Assembly District

First-term Democratic Assemblymember John Harabedian is up against Republican Adam Christopher Vena, a sanitation employee. The two automatically advanced to the general election since they were the only two to run in the primary.

This district represents voters in Pasadena, Altadena, La Cañada Flintridge, Monrovia and Sierra Madre in Los Angeles County and Rancho Cucamonga, Wrightwood and San Antonio Heights in San Bernardino County.

42nd Assembly District

Agoura Hills Councilmember Deborah Klein Lopez, a Democrat, and small business owner Ted Nordblum, a Republican, are running against each other after advancing out of a three-person primary race.

The winner will replace termed out Assemblymember Jacqui Irwin, D-Thousand Oaks, who is running for a U.S. House seat being vacated by retiring Rep. Julia Brownley.

The district includes portions of Ventura and Los Angeles counties, including Simi Valley, Thousand Oaks, Calabasas and Pacific Palisades.

43rd Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember Celeste Rodriguez faces off again against Republican Ricardo Benitez, a plumber and electrical contractor, who was her lone challenger in the primary.

This San Fernando Valley district represents Pacoima, Mission Hills, Sylmar, Arleta, Sun Valley, Panorama City, Lake View Terrace, Valley Glen, Van Nuys and San Fernando.

44th Assembly District

Assemblymember Nick Schultz, a Democrat, seeks a second term as he goes toe-to-toe with Republican Carolyn Daniels, an independent contractor. The two advanced from a three-person primary contest.

The district represents residents in the San Fernando Valley and stretches from Sherman Oaks east through North Hollywood and Burbank and north to La Crescenta.

46th Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel, who is seeking a fifth term, will go toe-to-toe again with his only challenger in the primary, Republican Tracey Schroeder, who is a teacher.

The two also squared off two years ago.

The winner will represent western San Fernando Valley in Los Angeles County and a small portion of Ventura County. Communities include Encino and Van Nuys near its eastern border and West Hills and Woodland Hills further west.

48th Assembly District

Assemblymember Blanca Rubio, a Democrat first elected in 2016, wants a sixth and final term. She faces off again against her sole challenger in the primary, Republican Dan Tran, a real estate businessman whom Rubio beat two years ago.

The winner will represent a swath of the San Gabriel Valley, including West Covina, Baldwin Park, Glendora, Covina, Azusa, Duarte and Monrovia.

49th Assembly District

Assemblymember Mike Fong, a Democrat first elected in a special election in February 2022, is up against Republican Long "David" Liu, the chief executive of The Liu Law Firm. The two also ran against each other two years ago.

Whoever wins will represent communities in the San Gabriel Valley, including Alhambra, Arcadia, El Monte, Monterey Park, Rosemead, San Gabriel, San Marino, South Pasadena and Temple City.

51st Assembly District

Assemblymember Rick Chavez Zbur, who was first elected in 2022, and challenger Colin Hernandez, a digital communications strategist and fellow Democrat, will go head-to-head after advancing from a five-person primary race.

This district represents Hollywood, West Hollywood, Beverly Hills and Santa Monica.

52nd Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember Jessica Caloza seeks a second term in this rematch with musician Andrea Lee Anderson, a Republican and the only person to challenge the incumbent in the primary.

The winner will represent East Los Angeles, including the neighborhoods of Lincoln Heights, Highland Park, Glassell Park, Eagle Rock, Los Feliz, Silver Lake and Echo Park.

53rd Assembly District

Assemblymember Michelle Rodriguez, a Democrat seeking a second term, faces off again against her only challenger in the primary, Republican Rafaela Romero, a special education aide.

The district includes parts of Los Angeles and San Bernardino counties, including Pomona, Ontario, Chino, Upland and Montclair.

54th Assembly District

Assemblymember Mark Gonzalez, a Democrat seeking a second term, is running unopposed.

He represents a district that includes L.A.'s Koreatown, Westlake, Chinatown, Little Tokyo and Boyle Heights, as well as the cities of Vernon and Montebello.

55th Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember Isaac Bryan, first elected in 2021, faces school social worker Ashley Brown, a fellow Democrat, after the two advanced from a four-person primary race.

This district represents Crenshaw, Culver City, Ladera Heights, Mar Vista, Del Rey, Palms, Pico-Robertson, Beverly Grove and Mid-Wilshire.

56th Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember Lisa Calderon, who was first elected in 2020, faces off again against her only challenger in the primary, Republican Jessica Martinez, a retired teacher.

The winner will represent the southeastern parts of Los Angeles County and the San Gabriel Valley, including El Monte, Hacienda Heights, La Habra Heights, La Puente, Pico Rivera and Whittier.

57th Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember Sade Elhawary, hoping for a second term, will face off against Republican Constance Jewel Menzies, an in-home care provider who was also Elhawary's only challenger in the primary.

The district represents South Central and downtown Los Angeles and includes the area around Exposition Park, Florence and Firestone Park.

61st Assembly District

Assemblymember Tina McKinnor, a Democrat first elected in 2022, is running unopposed.

Her district includes Inglewood, Venice, Westchester, Hawthorne, Westmont and Lawndale.

62nd Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember José Luis Solache, who is seeking a second term, is up against Republican Paul Irving Jones, a retired Marine. The two also ran against each other two years ago.

This district represents voters in Bellflower, Huntington Park, Lakewood, Lynwood, Maywood, Paramount, South Gate and Walnut Park.

64th Assembly District

Assemblymember Blanca Pacheco, a Democrat, is being challenged by Republican Raul Ortiz Jr., a pest control manager.

Just like in 2024, the two will battle it out to represent Southeast L.A. and a small portion of Orange County, including Bell, Bell Gardens, Cudahy, Downey, East Whittier, La Mirada, Norwalk, Santa Fe Springs, South Whittier and La Habra.

65th Assembly District

Compton school board member Ayanna Davis, a Democrat, is facing off against public school teacher Lydia Gutiérrez, a Republican, after the two advanced from a six-person primary race.

The winner will replace termed-out Assemblymember Mike Gipson, D-Carson, who is running for a seat on the state Board of Equalization.

The district stretches from the Port of Los Angeles up to Compton and includes parts of Carson and Long Beach.

66th Assembly District

Rancho Palos Verdes Mayor Paul Seo and Palos Verdes Peninsula Unified school board President Sara Deen are going toe-to-toe after the two advanced from a six-person primary race.

The winner will succeed termed-out Assemblymember Al Muratsuchi, D-Torrance.

With no incumbent running, this year's Democrat-versus-Democrat race has turned what has typically been a sleepy race for this district into one where voters are being inundated with television or digital ads, mailers or text messages on a daily basis.

The 66th Assembly District includes many of Los Angeles County's South Bay communities, from El Segundo and Manhattan Beach and on down through Redondo Beach Torrance, Rancho Palos Verdes and San Pedro.

67th Assembly District

Republican Paulo Morales, a U.S. Marshals Service special deputy, and Cerritos City Councilmember Mark Pulido, a Democrat, are facing off after advancing from the primary, where six candidates ran to replace termed-out Assemblymember Sharon Quirk-Silva, D-Fullerton.

Pulido edged out Ada Briceño, co-president of Unite Here Local 11 and the former chair of the Orange County Democratic Party, to secure his spot in the runoff.

This district includes Artesia, Cerritos and Hawaiian Gardens in southeastern Los Angeles County, plus Buena Park, Fullerton and Cypress in northern Orange County.

69th Assembly District

Assemblymember Josh Lowenthal, who is seeking a third term, is running again against fellow Democrat Carolyn Essex, a policy analyst, and Lowenthal's only challenger in the primary.

The winner will represent parts of southern Los Angeles County, including Avalon, Carson and Long Beach.

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